



The New Bill of Rights

FREEDOM · DEMOCRACY · RULE OF LAW · GOOD GOVERNMENT

A nonpartisan project to advance a new group of constitutional amendments — only the ones that Americans across the whole political spectrum already support.

The idea

The Constitution can be amended only with overwhelming consensus: two-thirds of Congress and three-fourths of the states. We treat that bar as the organizing principle, not the obstacle. Every proposal is judged by its **bipartisan floor** — the level of support in the *less* supportive party, measured with independent polling, ballot results, and cross-party votes. The working bar is sixty percent or better in the less supportive party. Proposals that fail are set aside publicly, with their evidence, and can return only when the evidence changes. Seventy-five percent support overall with a 40% floor is a partisan idea with a good press release; we don't carry those.

Every draft is written to bind both parties equally, forever — all future presidents, all future majorities. We never cite one side's abuses without the other's, and each side gives up a weapon at the same moment the other does.

The nine amendments

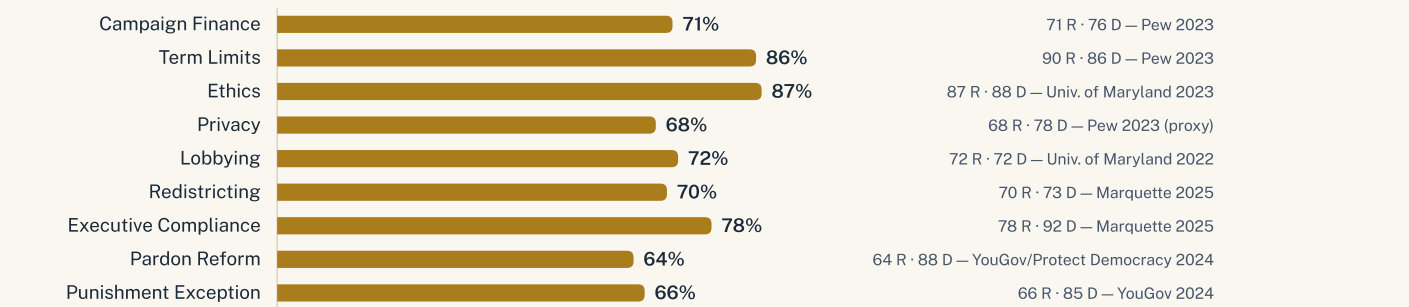
Each is a short statement of principle; the machinery is left to Congress and the states. The figure is the bipartisan floor — the lower of Republican and Democratic support — with the pollster and year.

- 1 Campaign Finance** — the For Our Freedom Amendment as American Promise publishes it, with one viewpoint-neutrality sentence added; plus a right to know who funds elections, bans on foreign money, and an express guarantee that the press and political speech stay protected. *Floor 71% (Pew, 2023).*
- 2 Term Limits** — three House terms and two Senate terms (the U.S. Term Limits amendment text, adopted word for word); staggered eighteen-year Supreme Court terms; a judicial retirement age — future officeholders only. *Floor 86% (Pew, 2023).*
- 3 Ethics** — no owning or trading individual stocks for senior officials in any branch; enforceable ethics rules, enforced from outside the officers they govern. *Floor 87% (University of Maryland, 2023).*
- 4 Privacy** — security against unreasonable governmental intrusion into private life; the government may not buy its way around a warrant by purchasing personal data; no suspicionless mass collection. *Floor 68% (Pew, 2023, on data-privacy regulation — the nearest polled proxy).*
- 5 Lobbying** — a five-year wait before senior officials lobby for pay; a lifetime ban on lobbying for foreign governments. *Floor 72% (University of Maryland, 2022).*
- 6 Redistricting** — districts drawn once per census, never redrawn mid-decade for advantage. *Floor 70% (Marquette, 2025).*
- 7 Executive Compliance with the Courts** — court judgments bind every officer of the United States, including the President; the right to appeal preserved. *Floor 78% (Marquette, 2025).*
- 8 Limited Presidential Pardon Reform** — every pardon published with recipient, offenses, and reasons; no pardons to family, for payment, or to shield the President. *Floor 64% (YouGov for Protect Democracy, 2024).*
- 9 Abolition of the Punishment Exception** — remove the Thirteenth Amendment's exception so the prohibition on slavery and involuntary servitude is unqualified; voluntary, paid prison work programs preserved. *Floor 66% (YouGov, 2024).*

How we work

Evidence before advocacy — every claim on the site is footnoted to a primary source, with party breakdowns, pollster, and year. **Principles, not machinery** — dollar amounts, thresholds, and agency designs belong in legislation. **Ratify consensus; don't manufacture it** — research, commissioned polling, salons, and state-level work come first, so the amendment is asked to carry agreement the country has already reached.

The nine floors at a glance



The bar is each amendment's bipartisan floor — support in the *less* supportive party. The full party breakdown, pollster, and question wording for every figure are published at newbillofrights.net/polling.

Why now

77%

say the political system needs major changes or complete reform

27%

are confident that change can actually happen

49%

are “pessimistic reformers” — want major change, don't believe it will come

Pew Research Center, spring 2025 survey; no party split published for these questions.

Over the past decade each party has held the presidency, and each has watched powers it once defended used in ways it opposed. That experience shows up in the numbers — and the numbers that held through changes of administration are the ones this project is built on. Half the country wants structural change and does not believe it can happen. The evidence that both parties already agree on specific changes is the answer to that disbelief.

What we set aside, and why

Twelve categories have been rejected on the evidence so far — among them abortion, voting rights, the Electoral College, Supreme Court expansion, and a balanced-budget requirement — and each has a public page naming the test it failed and what would reopen it. Twenty-three further ideas are held as candidates, each published with the specific evidence — for most, a drafted poll question — that would resolve it. The point is not that these ideas are wrong; it is that the evidence of full-spectrum support is not there yet.

Where the project stands

Started by Michael Hamilton, who lives in Los Angeles. The research corpus and all nine drafts are public at newbillofrights.net. Incorporation as the New Bill of Rights Foundation and the founding-donor round are next; the first monthly Los Angeles salon is planned for October 2026, with the room built to be visibly full-spectrum.

What we ask

- **Come to a salon** — and bring one person from the other side.
- **Read one thing and tell us what's wrong with it.** Corrections are recorded with attribution.
- **Take a discussant seat** — a named speaking role — at a future salon.
- **Volunteer** — research, polling, analytics, salon organizing, fundraising; lawyers: incorporation and 501(c)(3) filing pro bono.
- **Found** — join the founding-donor round or the founding board.

Take it with you

Read the evidence
All nine drafts, the polling, and everything we rejected — with reasons.
newbillofrights.net

Volunteer
Research, polling, analytics, salon organizing, fundraising, pro bono legal.
newbillofrights.net/get-involved/volunteer

Become a founding donor
Help incorporate the foundation — founding donors seat the first board.
newbillofrights.net/get-involved/seed-donors